

SWINBURNE UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

BUSINESS DESCRIPTION

Unit Code: Computing Technology Project A (COS40005)
Project: Internal Assistant for Enterprise Knowledge (Slack chatbot with RAG)
Client: Katalon, Inc. (replacing the original VIB client)
Team: Group 7
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A. Purpose of the Document

First and foremost, based on the recent transition of our project client from VIB to Katalon due to strict confidentiality constraints regarding internal banking data, this document establishes a comprehensive, business-focused understanding of the new operational scenario before any technical design is revisited. Furthermore, it details who Katalon is, how the company monetizes its offerings, who its primary customers and competitors are, and where its strategic roadmap is heading. Additionally, the final sections translate these business facts into concrete technical implications and open questions for our internal-knowledge Slack assistant.

Moreover, all factual claims are rigorously referenced in APA style, as shown in the references section. In instances where public sources diverge, the discrepancies are stated explicitly rather than resolved through arbitrary assumptions. Finally, sections eleven and twelve contain the team's independent critical analysis and are clearly labelled as such.

B. Executive Summary

- Katalon, Inc. is a privately held, Atlanta-headquartered software company that sells an AI-augmented software testing and quality management platform (Katalon, n.d.-a; Lagonsin, 2026).
- It was incubated inside KMS Technology, a U.S.–Vietnam engineering firm co-founded by Vu Lam, who is Katalon's Founder and CEO; a large share of engineering is based in Ho Chi Minh City (KMS Technology, n.d.; Unify, 2025).
- Katalon reports more than 30,000 teams as customers, a community of over 120,000 testing professionals and 120+ technology partners (Katalon, n.d.-a).
- Revenue model: freemium plus annual per-seat SaaS subscriptions (Free, Professional at US$1,000/seat/year promotional, custom Enterprise) and paid add-ons (Katalon, n.d.-b).
- Funding: one disclosed external round, a US$27 million Series A led by Elephant in June 2021 (Newswire, 2021).
- Strategy in 2026: a pivot from "test automation tool" to an **agentic quality platform** — the Katalon True Platform (launched April 2026), TrueTest and autonomous "Run with AI" agents, with governance features such as audit trails and human approval gates (Lagonsin, 2026; Katalon, 2026a).
- Analyst position: Visionary in the 2025 Gartner Magic Quadrant for AI-Augmented Software Testing Tools, and one of 12 vendors evaluated in the October 2026 Magic Quadrant for Agentic Software Quality Assurance Platforms (Katalon, 2025; Gartner, 2026).

C. Company Profile at a Glance

Attribute	Detail	Source
Legal name	Katalon, Inc.	Newswire (2021)
Ownership	Private, venture-backed	Caplight (n.d.)
Founded	2016 per the company; some databases list 2015. The Katalon Studio product was first released in January 2015, which likely explains the discrepancy.	Katalon (2025); Wikipedia (n.d.)

Attribute	Detail	Source
Headquarters	1720 Peachtree Street NW, Suite 870, Atlanta, GA 30309, USA	Katalon (n.d.-a)
Key engineering hub	Katalon Vietnam Co., Ltd., Viettel Tower, District 10, Ho Chi Minh City (office opened June 2022)	Advertising Vietnam (2022)
Industry	Software publisher – software testing / quality engineering SaaS	LeadIQ (n.d.)
Headcount	Estimates vary widely: 137 (Unify, July 2025), 201–500 (LeadIQ), 400+ (Salestools). Treat as unconfirmed.	Unify (2025); LeadIQ (n.d.)
Customers / reach	30,000+ teams; 120,000+ community members; 120+ technology partners	Katalon (n.d.-a)
Total disclosed funding	US$27M Series A (June 2021), led by Elephant	Newswire (2021)
Certifications	ISO and SOC certified; AWS partner; Great Place to Work-certified three years running	Katalon (n.d.-a)

D. History and Origins

4.1 The KMS Technology incubator

Katalon's roots are in KMS Technology, launched in 2008 by Vu Lam with the idea of using Vietnamese engineering talent to build software products rather than only provide outsourcing (Purdue University, 2014). KMS describes an internal incubator, KMS Labs, whose best-known spin-offs include QASymphony, Kobiton, Katalon and Grove (ITviec, n.d.). QASymphony — another testing company — raised US$40 million from IVP in 2017 and was later acquired by Tricentis, which is now one of Katalon's main competitors (KMS Technology, 2018).

4.2 Founder background

Vu Lam fled Vietnam by refugee boat as a child, later studied electrical engineering at Purdue University, and returned to build software teams in Vietnam (Purdue University, 2014). His stated ambition is to bring "made in Vietnam" software to the global market (KMS Technology, 2018). This matters for our project: the client has a dual U.S.–Vietnam identity, and our team is culturally and geographically close to its main engineering base.

4.3 Key milestones

Date	Milestone	Source
Jan 2015	Katalon Studio first released, initially as freeware	Wikipedia (n.d.)
2016	Katalon, Inc. established (company-stated founding year)	Katalon (2025)
Mar 2021	First Great Place to Work certification	Advertising Vietnam (2022)
Jun 2021	US$27M Series A led by Elephant	Newswire (2021)
Jun 2022	Katalon Vietnam entity and 1,800 m² HCMC office opened; MoUs with VNU-HCM University of Science and Fulbright University Vietnam	Advertising Vietnam (2022)
Apr 2025	TrueTest general availability (learns from real production user behaviour)	ANI News (2025)
Aug 2025	Philippe Vincent joins as President (go-to-market)	MarketScreener (n.d.)
Oct 2025	Named Visionary, 2025 Gartner MQ for AI-Augmented Software	Katalon (2025)

Date	Milestone	Source
	Testing Tools	
Apr 2026	Katalon True Platform launched; “Run with AI” agent beta	Lagonsin (2026); TestCollab (2026)
Oct 2026	Evaluated in the first Gartner MQ for Agentic Software QA Platforms	Gartner (2026)

E. Leadership and Governance

Name	Role
Vu Lam	Founder & CEO; Chair of the Board
Philippe Vincent	President
Uy Tran	Co-Founder & COO
Tien Anh Nguyen	Chief Financial Officer
Cristiano Caetano	SVP, Product
Rajesh Krishnan	SVP, Engineering
Minh Nguyen	General Counsel
Alex Estevez, Jon Hallett, Josh Lieberman, Jeremiah Daly	Board of Directors

Source: Katalon (n.d.-a). Josh Lieberman is also a co-founder of KMS Technology (KMS Technology, n.d.), and Alex Estevez previously served as CFO of BigFix (sold to IBM) (Newswire, 2022). The board composition signals investor and operator experience in scaling and exiting software companies.

F. Products and Platform

Katalon positions itself as “the AI platform for software quality”, offering agentic testing that unifies testing workflows (Katalon, n.d.-c). The portfolio has evolved from a single desktop IDE into a multi-product platform:

Product	What it does	Source
Katalon Studio	Low-code / scripted (Groovy) test authoring for web, API, mobile and desktop; current versions 11.x	Katalon (2026a); Sig.ai (2026)
Katalon True Platform	Unified system for automation, manual testing, execution, analytics, test management and production monitoring, wrapped in audit trails, traceability and human approval controls	Lagonsin (2026)
Katalon AI (Assistant)	Natural-language assistant that turns requests into testing workflows; reads project documents, Knowledge Base, Agent Rules and Project Memory	Katalon (2026a, 2026c)
Run with AI	Autonomous agent that executes a test against the live app and returns a runnable Studio script (beta from 2026)	Katalon (2026b)
TrueTest	AI-native system that observes real users in production, identifies critical journeys and auto-generates tests	ANI News (2025)
TestOps / TestCloud / Runtime Engine	Analytics and orchestration; cloud execution; command-line execution for CI/CD	Yespress (n.d.); Katalon (n.d.-b)
MCP Server	Model Context Protocol server letting external AI clients work with Katalon data under existing project permissions	Katalon (2026c)

> *Business insight: Katalon ships product updates monthly (e.g., May, August, September and October 2026 roundups). Its own documentation and release notes therefore change quickly — directly relevant to our "knowledge-base freshness" criterion (30%).*

G. Business Model and Pricing

7.1 Revenue model

Katalon follows a **product-led growth (freemium) model**: a free tier attracts individual testers, and revenue comes from annual per-seat subscriptions plus usage-related add-ons (Katalon, n.d.-b). Its large community, free Katalon Academy training and forum act as low-cost acquisition channels (Katalon, n.d.-a). Global system integrators such as Cognizant and QualityKiosk act as partners that bring the platform to enterprise clients (Lagonsin, 2026).

7.2 Published pricing (as of November 2026)

Plan	Price	Key inclusions
Free	US$0; 30-day trial	Local authoring and execution, record and playback, Git, reports; up to 40 static test suites
Professional	US$1,000 per seat per year (promotional; list US$2,199)	AI agents for authoring, failure analysis and self-healing; MCP server; web/mobile/API/desktop; CI/CD; integrations with Jira, GitHub, GitLab, Slack, Azure DevOps; 24/5 support
Enterprise	Custom annual contract	SSO/SAML, SCIM, role-based access control, audit logs, private cloud / on-premises / air-gapped, bring-your-own AI provider, dedicated CSM, SLA
Add-ons	Priced separately	Premier Support; Runtime Engine (headless/CI); TestCloud (cloud execution)

Source: Katalon (n.d.-b). Note that Enterprise-tier features — RBAC, audit logs, SSO and air-gapped deployment — show that Katalon's own enterprise customers care strongly about access control and data security.

H. Customers and Market Reach

Katalon displays logos including Vodafone, UnitedHealthcare, Red Bull, Petronas, Nvidia, Nasdaq, ING, Accenture, FEMA, MINDEF Singapore and the U.S. Department of State, and publishes case studies with GE Digital and Liberty Latin America (Katalon, n.d.-a). Liberty Latin America reportedly saved over 2,400 work hours and halved regression-testing time (Katalon, n.d.-a). Earlier press materials state usage across more than 160 countries (Newswire, 2022).

The customer base therefore spans banking and finance, telecoms, healthcare, energy, government and defence — many of them regulated sectors. The company calls its target user the "hybrid tester", a professional who blends manual, automation and AI skills (Katalon, 2025).

> *Caution: logo walls and case-study figures are vendor marketing and have not been independently verified.*

I. Market and Industry Context

9.1 Market size

Market-research firms disagree on size because they define the market differently. Grand View Research estimates the global software testing market at about US$49.4 billion in 2025, growing

at 8.5% CAGR to 2033 (GII Korea, 2026). The narrower automation-testing segment is estimated at US$24.25 billion in 2026, rising to US$84.22 billion by 2034 (Fortune Business Insights, via GII, 2026). Gartner forecast spending on testing tools specifically at US$2.8 billion in 2025 (Spotlight AR, 2025) — this is the segment Katalon actually sells into.

9.2 Key trends

- **AI-generated code creates a validation bottleneck.** Gartner notes that AI coding agents are generating software faster than teams can validate it (quoted in PR Newswire, 2026).
- **Shift from AI-assisted to agentic testing.** Gartner renamed its category in 2026 to "Agentic Software Quality Assurance Platforms", signalling a move from copilot-style help to agent-driven autonomy (Gartner, 2026; RPA Bots World, 2026).
- **Rapid adoption.** Gartner projects that 70% of enterprises will have integrated AI-augmented testing tools by 2028, up from about 20% in early 2025 (Spotlight AR, 2025).
- **Governance and trust.** The credible agentic products all retain a human approval gate (TestCollab, 2026), which is exactly how Katalon markets True Platform.

J. Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Type	Positioning vs Katalon
Tricentis (Tosca, qTest, Testim)	Enterprise platform	Gartner Leader in 2025 and 2026; positioned furthest on Completeness of Vision in 2026 (AIthority, 2026). Owns QASymphony, a fellow KMS spin-off.
SmartBear (TestComplete, ReadyAPI)	Enterprise tools	Strong in API testing; included in 2026 MQ (Gartner, 2026).
Keysight, UiPath, OpenText	Large diversified vendors	Keysight and UiPath named Leaders in 2026 (Keysight, 2026; RPA Bots World, 2026).
TestMu AI, mabl, ACCELQ	AI-native challengers	TestMu AI a Leader; mabl a Challenger in 2026 (TestMu AI, 2026; PR Newswire, 2026).
BrowserStack, Sauce Labs	Execution clouds	Most frequently compared alternative on Gartner Peer Insights (Gartner Peer Insights, n.d.).
Selenium, Playwright, Cypress, Appium	Free open-source frameworks	Code-first and free; Katalon's value proposition is lowering their setup complexity (Sig.ai, 2026).

Katalon's differentiation rests on (a) an all-in-one platform for mixed-skill teams, (b) price accessibility relative to enterprise suites, (c) TrueTest's use of real production behaviour, and (d) its governance framing for AI agents. Gartner's 2025 "Visionary" label means a vendor understands where the market is going but does not yet execute as well as Leaders (Katalon, 2025b). Katalon's exact quadrant in the 2026 report could not be confirmed from public sources at the time of writing.

K. SWOT Analysis (Team Analysis)

> *This section is the team's interpretation of the evidence above, not a sourced fact.*

Strengths	Weaknesses
Large user base (30k+ teams) and community; freemium funnel; broad platform coverage; fast monthly release cadence; cost-efficient Vietnam engineering;	Modest disclosed funding (US$27M) versus larger rivals; Gartner Visionary rather than Leader in 2025 suggests execution gap; unclear public headcount; brand

Strengths	Weaknesses
ISO/SOC certifications.	still tied to “Katalon Studio” tool image.
Opportunities	**Threats**
AI-generated code increases demand for validation; enterprise adoption of AI testing expected to rise sharply by 2028; MCP and agent ecosystems; partner channel via global system integrators.	Well-funded Leaders (Tricentis, Keysight, UiPath) and AI-native start-ups; free open-source frameworks (Playwright) keep price pressure high; coding agents may embed their own testing.

L. Implications for Our Project (Team Analysis)

Our deliverable is unchanged in shape — a Slack assistant that answers employee questions from internal knowledge using RAG, with automated ingestion and access control. The business context above changes **what problems the bot must solve** and **how we should pitch it**:

- **Knowledge volume and churn are high.** Katalon runs many products (Studio, True Platform, TrueTest, TestOps, MCP) with monthly releases and versioned docs (Studio 11.2 to 11.7 within 2026). Freshness and version-awareness will matter more than they would at a bank.
- **Distributed workforce.** Teams sit in Atlanta, Ho Chi Minh City, India and remote locations (Unify, 2025). A Slack bot reduces time-zone dependency — a strong business-value argument.
- **Likely user groups (to confirm):** engineering, QA, customer support / customer success (troubleshooting answers), sales and pre-sales (pricing, competitor and feature questions), and onboarding of new hires.
- **Access control remains critical.** Customer contracts, enterprise pricing and security reviews should not be visible to every employee; Katalon itself sells RBAC and audit logs, so it will judge our permission layer by its own standard.
- **Credibility with the client.** Katalon publicly emphasises audit trails, traceability and human approval for AI. Our bot should cite sources in every answer and log queries — this aligns with how the client already thinks about trustworthy AI.
- **Data-sensitivity risk.** The VIB engagement ended over information leakage; we should propose synthetic or public data first (e.g., docs.katalon.com, release notes, blog) and escalate to internal data only under an agreed data-handling plan.

M. Open Questions for the Client Mentor

1. Which internal knowledge sources should be in scope (Confluence, Google Drive, Notion, Jira, docs site), and which tool is the system of record?
2. Which teams are the primary users, and what are their top recurring questions?
3. What permission model exists today (groups, spaces, roles) that the access-control layer must mirror?
4. May we use real internal data, or should we start with public documentation and synthetic internal documents?
5. Is Amazon Bedrock still the required LLM platform, or does Katalon prefer another provider (its Enterprise plan supports “bring your own AI provider”)?

6. Who is our named mentor at Katalon, and what success metrics would make the bot valuable to them?

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